Euclid Book I: Reconstruction

CGJteamLab

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Contents

Chapter 1

Proposition I.1

Euclid's first proposition in Book I is usually presented as the straightforward construction obtained from the intersection of two circles. A formal reconstruction, however, reveals two logically independent problems: the existence of a common point of the corresponding circles and the proof that the resulting point does not lie on the line determined by the given base.

The proof of non-collinearity relies on the classical idea that a proper part of a segment cannot be congruent to the entire segment. This argument is well known from modern axiomatic reconstructions of geometry, including the work of Michael Beeson and his collaborators.

The purpose of this note is not to present a new geometric proof. Rather, it is to demonstrate that, once Book Zero has been developed, this argument becomes a direct application of the previously established theory. Proposition I.1 therefore serves as the first experimental test of Book Zero as an intermediate language for synthetic proofs.

1.1 The Classical Construction

Let $A \neq B$. Euclid constructs two circles of radius AB: the first centered at A, the second centered at B. One of their points of intersection is denoted by C.

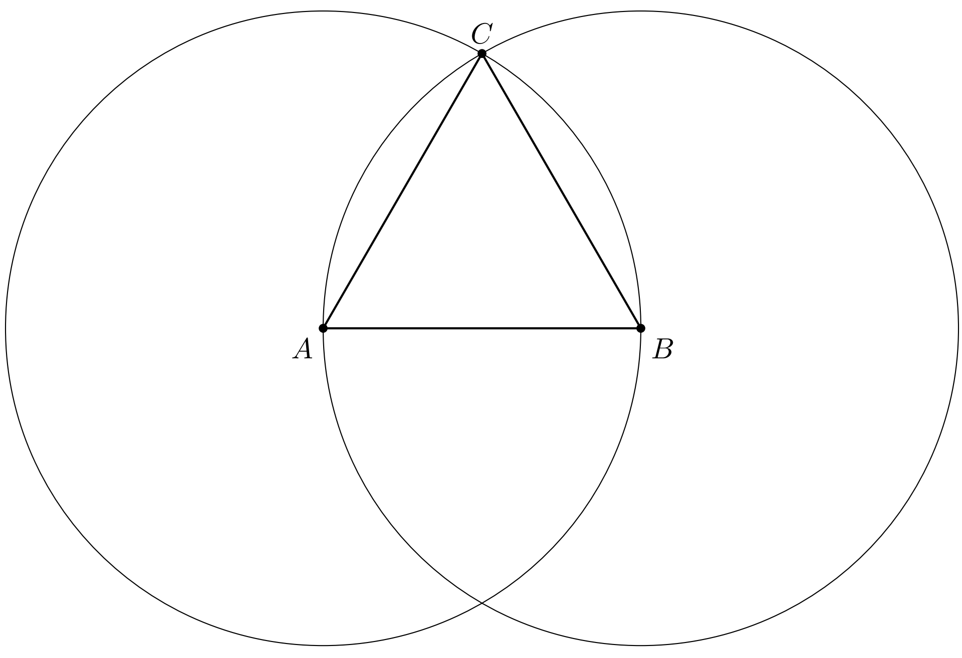


Figure 1.1: Euclid's classical construction. The point C is a common point of two circles of radius AB.

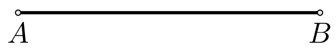
From the construction we obtain

$$AC \cong AB, \qquad BC \cong AB.$$

Formally, however, this is not yet a complete proof. One must also show that the points A, B, C are not collinear.

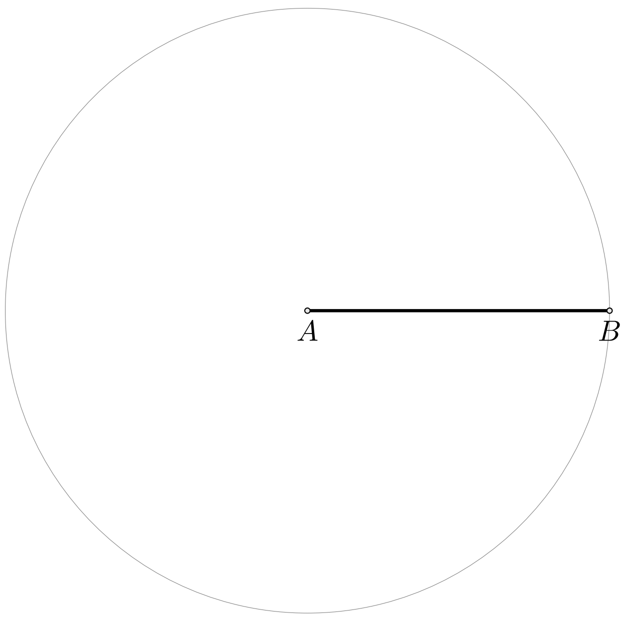
Step 1. Given Segment

The construction starts with a given segment AB.



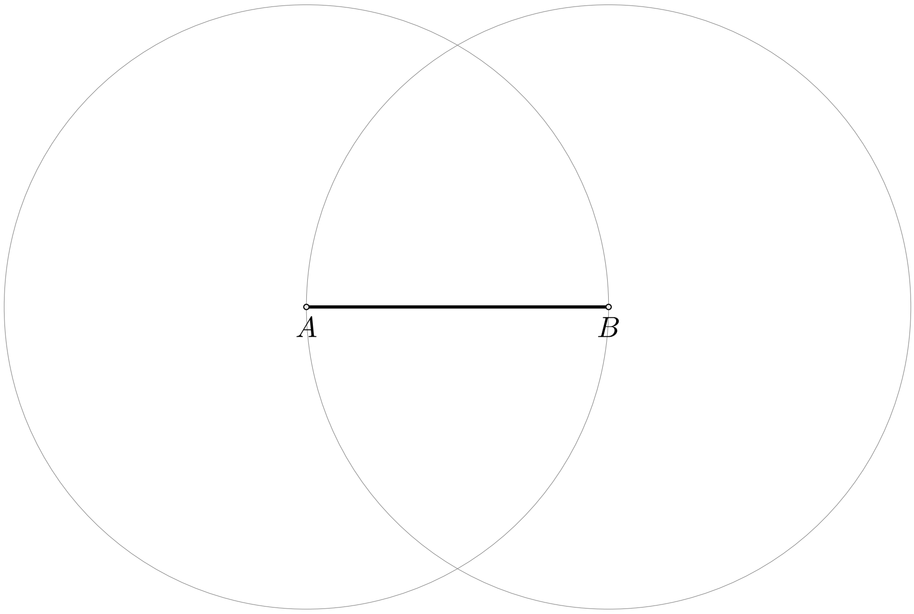
Step 2. Draw the Circle Centered at A

Draw the circle centered at A through B.



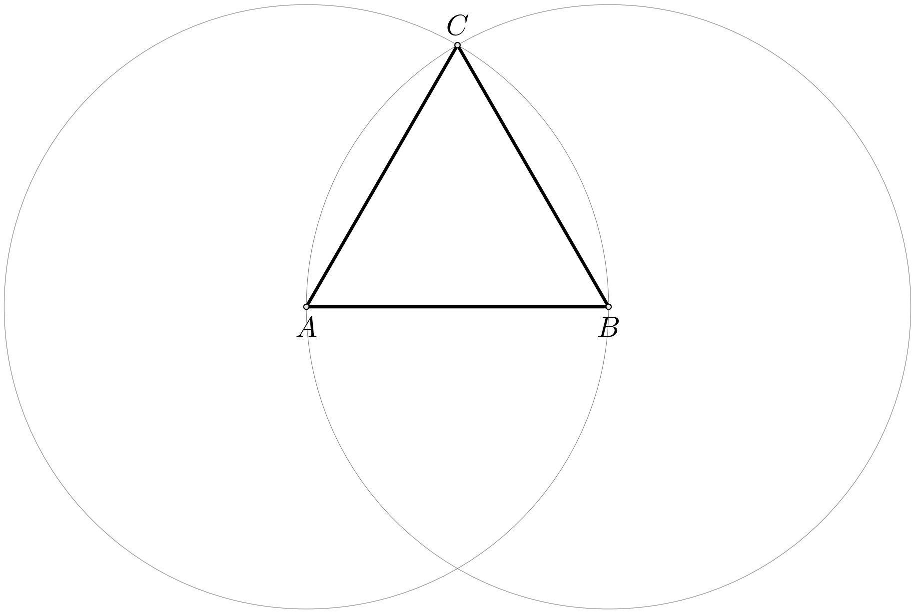
Step 3. Draw the Circle Centered at B

Draw the circle centered at B through A.



Step 4. Construct the Equilateral Triangle

Let C be one of the intersection points of the two circles. Join AC and BC to obtain the equilateral triangle.



1.2 Separating the Two Problems

The reconstruction reveals two logically independent stages.

1. **Existence stage.** One must obtain a point C such that

$$AC \cong AB, \qquad BC \cong AB.$$

   In the current version of the project, this stage is provided by the temporary principle `hilbert_equidistant_point_exists`. Ultimately, it is intended to be derived from an appropriate theory of continuity in Hilbert geometry.

2. **Synthetic stage.** From the congruences above one must derive
$$\neg\,\mathrm{Collinear}(A, B, C).$$
This stage no longer requires any theory of circles.

1.3 Theorem

Theorem. Let $A \neq B$. Assume that there exists a point C such that
$$AC \cong AB, \qquad BC \cong AB.$$
Then the points A, B, C are not collinear.

1.4 Proof

First observe that $C \neq A$ and $C \neq B$. If $C = A$, then $AC \cong AB$ would imply that a null segment is congruent to the non-null segment AB. Similarly, $C \neq B$.

Now suppose, for contradiction, that the points A, B, C are collinear. Since they are pairwise distinct, the trichotomy of the order of points on a line gives exactly three possibilities:
$$A - B - C, \qquad B - A - C, \qquad A - C - B.$$

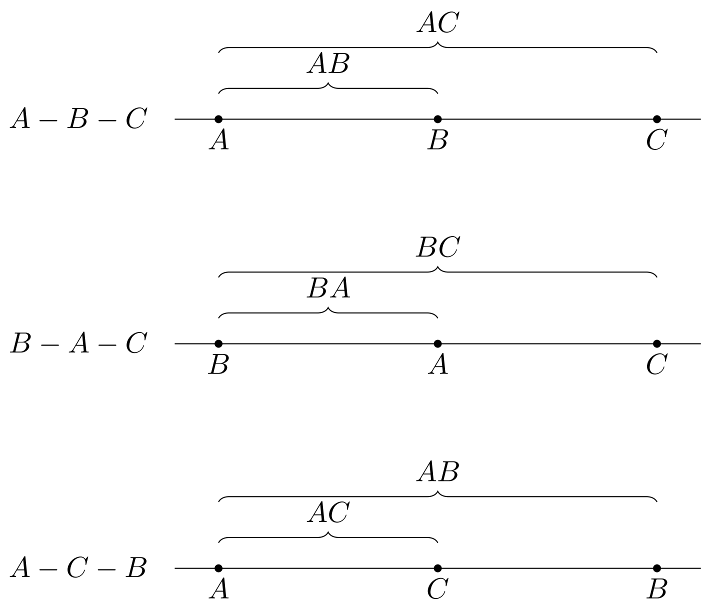


Figure 1.2: The three possible arrangements of pairwise distinct collinear points.

Case 1: $A - B - C$

The segment AB is a proper part of the segment AC. Book Zero contains the general theorem:

> A proper part of a segment cannot be congruent to the whole segment.

On the other hand, by assumption,
$$AC \cong AB.$$
Using symmetry of congruence, we obtain
$$AB \cong AC,$$
which is a contradiction.

Case 2: $B - A - C$

The segment BA is a proper part of the segment BC. Since

$$BC \cong AB,$$

and reversing the endpoints of a segment does not change its length, we have

$$BA \cong AB.$$

By transitivity of congruence, it follows that

$$BA \cong BC,$$

again contradicting the fact that a proper part cannot be congruent to the whole.

Case 3: $A - C - B$

The segment AC is a proper part of the segment AB. But the assumption directly gives

$$AC \cong AB.$$

This yields the third contradiction.

All possible collinear arrangements lead to a contradiction. Therefore,

$$\neg\,\mathrm{Collinear}(A, B, C).$$

□

1.5 Architecture of the Proof

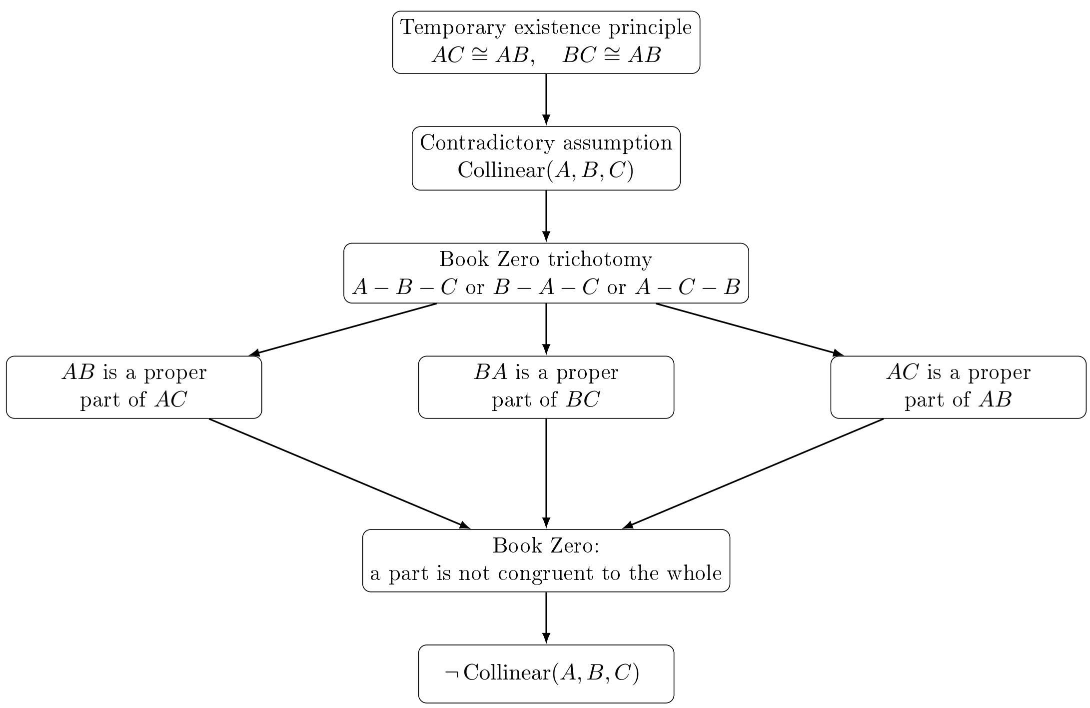


Figure 1.3: The structure of the proof of Proposition I.1 above the Book Zero layer.

1.6 Significance of the Reconstruction

The geometric result itself is not new. Constructing an equilateral triangle on a given segment is one of the classical theorems of elementary geometry.

Likewise, the idea underlying the proof of non-collinearity is not new. Modern axiomatic reconstructions, in particular the work of Michael Beeson and his collaborators, employ an analogous argument based on the theorem that a proper part of a segment cannot be congruent to the entire segment.

The novelty of the present reconstruction lies elsewhere.

The objective of the CGJteamLab project was not to discover a new proof of Proposition I.1, but to investigate whether the theory developed in Book Zero is sufficiently rich to serve as an intermediate language for synthetic proofs.

The experiment shows that, once the existence problem for an equidistant point has been isolated, the entire argument can be expressed almost exclusively in terms of the theorems previously established in Book Zero.

From the perspective of the architecture of the theory, this is more significant than Proposition I.1 itself. It demonstrates that Book Zero is not merely a collection of auxiliary lemmas, but rather forms a new layer of abstraction between Hilbert's axioms and classical synthetic reasoning.

Schematically, the situation may be represented as

$$\text{Hilbert's axioms} \longrightarrow \text{Book Zero} \longrightarrow \text{Proposition I.1}.$$

In this sense, Proposition I.1 constitutes the first experimental test confirming that Book Zero can serve as a language of synthetic proofs for the further reconstruction of Euclidean geometry.

Chapter 2

Proposition I.2

This note compares Euclid's original construction for Proposition I.2 with its reconstruction over the Hilbert foundation. In the CGJteamLab development the proposition follows immediately from Book Zero #49 (Layoff), illustrating the difference between the architectural roles of segment construction in Euclid's geometry and the Hilbert axiomatic framework.

2.1 Statement

Given a point A and a segment BC, construct a point D such that

$$AD \cong BC.$$

2.2 Euclid's Classical Construction

Euclid's construction proceeds as follows.

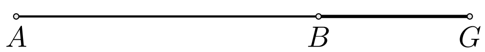
1. Construct the equilateral triangle DAB on the segment AB.
2. Produce the side DB beyond B.
3. Produce the side DA beyond A.
4. Draw the circle centered at B with radius BC.
5. Draw the circle centered at D with radius DG.
6. The constructed point L satisfies
$$AL \cong BC.$$

Step 1. Given data

The construction starts with a given point A and a given segment BG.

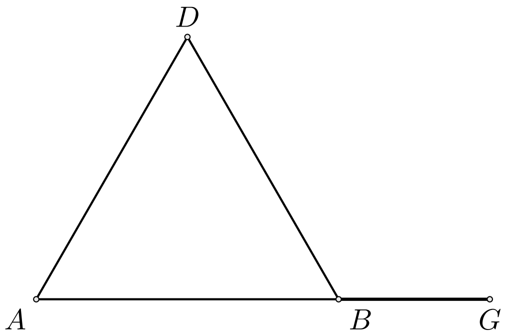
Step 2. Join AB

Join the given point A to the endpoint B of the given segment.



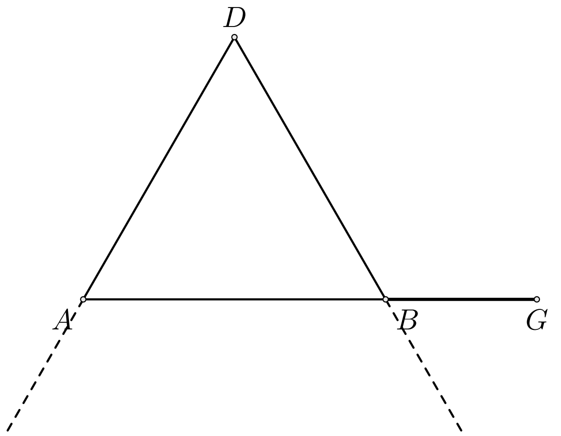
Step 3. Construct the equilateral triangle DAB

Construct the equilateral triangle DAB on the segment AB.



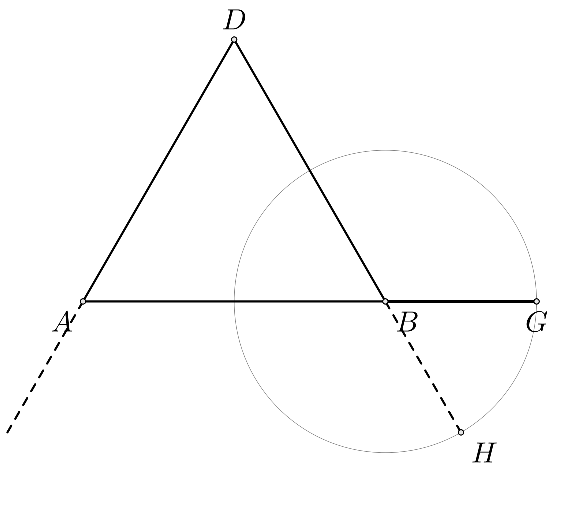
Step 4. Produce DA and DB

Produce DA beyond A and DB beyond B.



Step 5. Draw the circle centered at B

Draw the circle centered at B through G. Let H be the intersection of this circle with the line DB on the side beyond B.

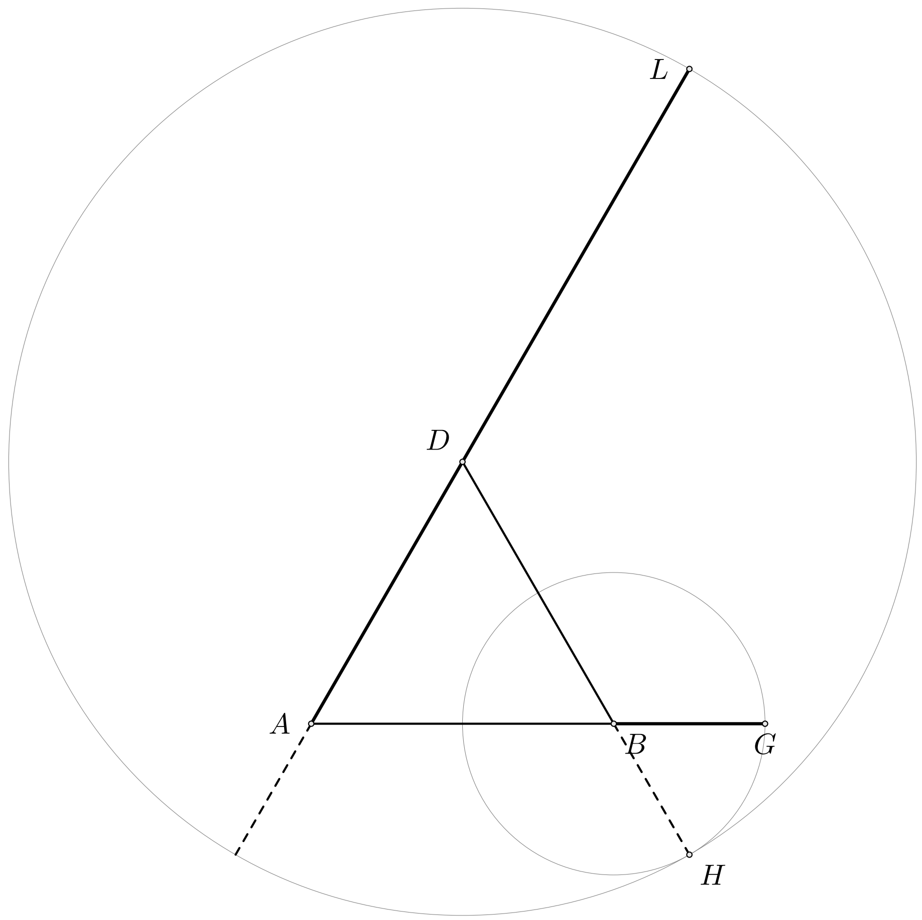


Since H lies on the circle centered at B through G,

$$BH \cong BG.$$

Step 6. Draw the circle centered at D

Draw the circle centered at D through H. Let L be the intersection of this circle with the line DA on the side beyond A.



Since L lies on the circle centered at D through H,

$$DL \cong DH.$$

The segment AL is therefore the required copy of the given segment.

2.3 Hilbert Reconstruction

The reconstruction over the Hilbert foundation is considerably shorter.

1. Choose any point $E \neq A$.
2. The ray AE is thereby determined.
3. Apply Book Zero #49 (Layoff).
4. Obtain a point D on the ray AE satisfying

$$AD \cong BC.$$

No auxiliary geometric construction is required.
Book Zero #49 provides a point D on a chosen ray from A such that

$$AD \cong BC.$$

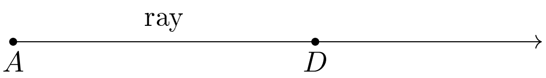


Figure 2.1: Lay off the segment on a chosen ray.

2.4 Formalization

The formal proof consists of a single application of Book Zero #49.

```
theorem euclid_proposition_2 ...
  := bookZero_49_layoff ...
```

2.5 Discussion

Thus Proposition I.2 illustrates a fundamental architectural difference between Euclid's geometry and the Hilbert approach.

In Euclid's *Elements*, the transport of a segment is obtained through a sequence of explicit geometric constructions beginning with Proposition I.1.

In contrast, Hilbert incorporates this operation into the congruence axioms. Book Zero encapsulates it in the Layoff Theorem, making Proposition I.2 an immediate consequence.

2.6 Book Zero #49: Layoff

The proof of Proposition I.2 relies on one of the elementary construction theorems established in Book Zero.

Book Zero #49 (Layoff). Let $A \neq B$ and $C \neq D$. Then there exists a point X on the ray AB such that

$$AX \cong CD.$$

In other words, every nondegenerate segment can be copied onto an arbitrarily chosen ray while preserving its length.

```
Input
-----

Ray AB

A----------------------------->

Segment CD

C-------------D


|
|  Book Zero #49
v


Output
```

```
------

A-----------------X------------>

AX congruent CD
```

This theorem provides the fundamental operation of transporting segments. Once it is available, Euclid's Proposition I.2 becomes an immediate consequence.

Chapter 3

Proposition I.3

3.1 Introduction

Euclid's third proposition asks for the construction of a segment equal to a given shorter segment on a given greater segment.

Classically, this construction is obtained by combining Proposition I.2 with an additional circle construction. A segment equal to the shorter one is first laid off from an endpoint of the greater segment, and a circle is then used to determine the required point on the greater segment.

In the present reconstruction over Hilbert geometry, the logical structure is substantially different. The theory developed in Book Zero already contains an abstract notion of one segment being less than another. This notion is defined by the existence of a point between the endpoints of the greater segment such that the corresponding subsegment is congruent to the smaller one.

Consequently, the existential content of Euclid's Proposition I.3 is already embodied in the definition of segment inequality. The reconstruction therefore consists not in repeating Euclid's geometric construction, but in exposing the witness contained in the definition of `HilbertSegmentLess`.

This proposition provides the first clear example where a classical Euclidean construction becomes an immediate consequence of the abstract language developed in Book Zero.

3.2 The Classical Construction

Euclid's third proposition asks for the construction of a segment equal to a given shorter segment on a given greater segment.

Unlike Proposition I.2, the present construction does not introduce a new geometric technique. Instead, it combines Proposition I.2 with one additional circle construction.

The construction proceeds as follows.

3.2.1 Final Configuration

The objective is to determine a point E on the greater segment AB such that

$$AE \cong CD.$$

The final geometric configuration is shown in Figure 1.

From the construction we obtain

$$AE \cong CD.$$

The remaining task is to justify that the point E lies between the endpoints of the greater segment.

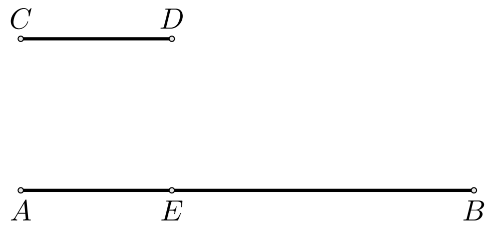


Figure 3.1: Final configuration of Euclid's construction for Proposition I.3.

3.2.2 Construction Algorithm

The construction uses Proposition I.2 as an already established construction primitive.

Step 1. Given Segments

Let AB be the greater segment and CD the given shorter segment.

Step 2. Apply Proposition I.2

By Proposition I.2, construct a segment AF congruent to the given segment CD.
Thus

$$AF \cong CD.$$

Step 3. Draw the Circle Centered at A

Draw the circle centered at A passing through F.

Step 4. Determine the Required Point

Let E be the intersection of the circle with the greater segment.
Since

$$AE \cong AF$$

and

$$AF \cong CD,$$

it follows that

$$AE \cong CD.$$

The required segment has therefore been obtained.

3.3 Proof

The classical Euclidean proof constructs the required point by applying Proposition I.2 and then introducing an auxiliary circle.

The reconstruction over Hilbert geometry follows a different logical route. The relation that one segment is less than another is already represented in Book Zero by the predicate

$$\texttt{HilbertSegmentLess}\ CD\ AB.$$

By definition, this predicate means that there exists a point E between the endpoints of the greater segment satisfying

$$A - E - B$$

and

$$AE \cong CD.$$

Therefore, assuming

$$CD < AB,$$

we immediately obtain a point E such that

$$A - E - B \qquad \text{and} \qquad AE \cong CD.$$

This is precisely the conclusion required by Proposition I.3.

Consequently, over the present Hilbert/Book Zero layer, the proposition is an immediate consequence of the definition of `HilbertSegmentLess`.

□

3.4 Proof Architecture

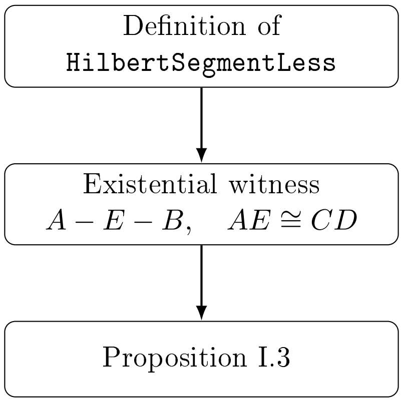


Figure 3.2: Logical structure of Proposition I.3 over the Book Zero layer.

3.5 Hilbert Reconstruction

Unlike Euclid's original proof, the present reconstruction does not repeat the geometric construction based on Proposition I.2.

The abstract notion of one segment being less than another has already been introduced in Book Zero by the predicate `HilbertSegmentLess`. By definition, this predicate contains exactly the existential information required by Proposition I.3.

Consequently, the reconstruction consists simply in extracting the witness from this definition.

This illustrates an important feature of the Book Zero layer. Classical geometric constructions are progressively replaced by abstract synthetic notions whose mathematical content has already been established.

3.6 Lean Formalization

The Lean formalization closely follows the mathematical argument.

The hypothesis

$$\texttt{HilbertSegmentLess}\ CD\ AB$$

already contains an existential witness providing the required point between the endpoints of the greater segment together with the corresponding congruence.

The formal proof therefore consists only of unpacking this witness and applying the symmetry of segment congruence.

Unlike the classical Euclidean proof, no additional geometric construction is required.

The resulting Lean theorem is therefore considerably shorter than the corresponding classical argument.

Chapter 4

Proposition I.4

4.1 Introduction

Euclid's fourth proposition is the first theorem on triangle congruence.

Unlike the preceding propositions, it does not describe a geometric construction. Instead, it establishes that two triangles are congruent whenever two corresponding sides and the included angle are equal.

Euclid's original proof relies on the method of superposition, one of the most discussed arguments in the *Elements*. Modern axiomatic systems generally avoid superposition as a primitive method of proof.

In the present reconstruction over Hilbert geometry, the proposition is obtained from the Side–Angle–Side (SAS) congruence theorem, which has already been established within the Hilbert theory.

Thus, while the mathematical content coincides with Euclid's Proposition I.4, the logical structure of the proof is fundamentally different.

4.2 The Classical Configuration

Unlike the first three propositions of Book I, Proposition I.4 is not a geometric construction. Instead, it establishes a criterion for the congruence of two triangles.

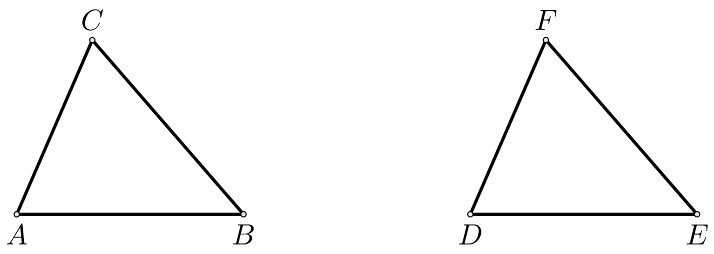
The proposition considers two triangles satisfying three geometric hypotheses:

- two pairs of corresponding sides are congruent;
- the included angles are congruent.

The objective is to prove that the triangles are congruent. As a consequence, the remaining corresponding side and the remaining corresponding angles are also congruent.

4.2.1 Final Configuration

The geometric configuration is shown in Figure 1.



Configuration of Proposition I.4.

The hypotheses are

$$AB \cong DE,$$

$$AC \cong DF,$$

and

$$\angle BAC \cong \angle EDF.$$

The desired conclusions are

$$BC \cong EF,$$

together with

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle DEF,$$

and

$$\angle ACB \cong \angle DFE.$$

4.3 Statement

Proposition I.4.

If two triangles have two corresponding sides congruent and the included angles congruent, then the triangles are congruent.

More precisely, let ABC and DEF be two non degenerate triangles:

$$AB \cong DE,$$

$$AC \cong DF,$$

and

$$\angle BAC \cong \angle EDF.$$

Then

$$BC \cong EF,$$

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle DEF,$$

and

$$\angle ACB \cong \angle DFE.$$

4.4 Proof

Euclid's original proof proceeds by superposition. One triangle is conceived as being placed upon the other in order to establish the coincidence of the corresponding sides and vertices.

The present reconstruction follows a different logical route. Superposition is not part of Hilbert's axiomatic system and therefore does not appear in the formal development.

Instead, the Side–Angle–Side congruence theorem has already been established within the Hilbert theory.

Applying the SAS theorem to the hypotheses

$$AB \cong DE,$$

$$AC \cong DF,$$

and

$$\angle BAC \cong \angle EDF$$

immediately yields the congruence of the two triangles.

Consequently,

$$BC \cong EF,$$

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle DEF,$$

and

$$\angle ACB \cong \angle DFE.$$

This is precisely the conclusion of Proposition I.4.

□

4.5 Proof Architecture

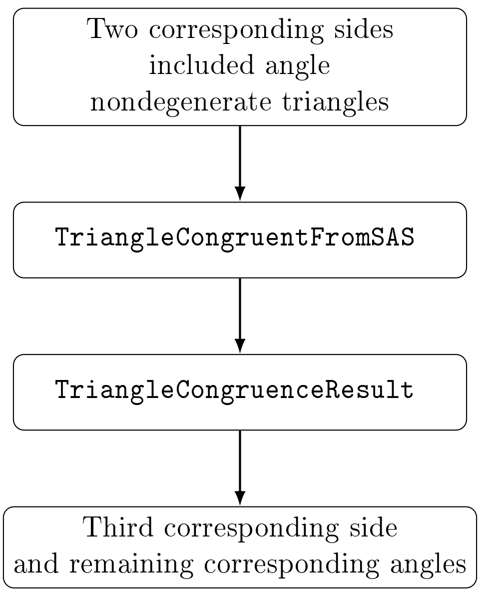


Figure 4.1: Logical structure of Proposition I.4 in the Hilbert reconstruction.

4.6 Hilbert Reconstruction

The principal difference between Euclid's original argument and the present reconstruction concerns the method of proof rather than the mathematical statement.

Euclid establishes Proposition I.4 by superposition, treating one triangle as if it could be placed upon the other. Although historically important, this method is not available within the Hilbert axiomatic framework.

Instead, the present development relies on the Side–Angle–Side congruence theorem, which has already been established as part of the Hilbert theory.

Once the hypotheses of the SAS theorem have been established, an application of `TriangleCongruentFromSAS` immediately yields the complete triangle congruence.

Thus the classical proposition is reconstructed without appealing to superposition while preserving exactly the same mathematical content.

4.7 Lean Formalization

The Lean theorem is a direct application of the previously established Hilbert SAS theorem, exposed through the compatibility theorem `TriangleCongruentFromSAS`.

In addition to the two side congruences and the congruence of the included angles, the formal statement explicitly records that both triples of vertices are noncollinear.

The theorem returns a value of type `TriangleCongruenceResult`. This structure contains the congruence of all three corresponding sides and all three corresponding angles.

Thus the formal proof of Proposition I.4 consists of a single application of `TriangleCongruentFromSAS`; no additional geometric argument is required.

From the viewpoint of formalization, Proposition I.4 is also the first result whose Lean proof is essentially a single application of a previously established interface theorem.

Chapter 5

Proposition I.5

5.1 Introduction

Proposition I.5 is the first theorem of Book I devoted specifically to the geometry of isosceles triangles. It establishes that the angles at the base of an isosceles triangle are congruent. Moreover, if the equal sides are extended beyond the base, the exterior angles formed by these extensions are also congruent.

In the Elements this proposition is one of the best known results of classical geometry and later became known under the traditional name *pons asinorum*. Although the theorem itself is elementary, it marks the beginning of a systematic study of congruence properties of triangles.

Euclid proves the proposition by combining the congruence theorem of Proposition I.4 with auxiliary constructions on the extensions of the equal sides.

In the present reconstruction the logical organization is different. The theorem is obtained by composing two previously established results of the Hilbert interface. The congruence of the base angles is provided by the theorem on isosceles triangles, while the congruence of the exterior angles follows from Hilbert's theorem on adjacent angles.

Consequently, Proposition I.5 is the first example in which a Euclidean proposition is reconstructed by combining several independent interface theorems rather than by introducing new geometric techniques.

5.2 The Classical Configuration

Euclid's proof of Proposition I.5 does not use only the original isosceles triangle and the extensions of its equal sides. It introduces additional auxiliary points and joins, producing a larger configuration to which Proposition I.4 can be applied.

Let ABC be an isosceles triangle satisfying

$$AB \cong AC.$$

Produce the equal sides AB and AC beyond the base vertices B and C. Euclid then chooses an auxiliary point on one extension, transfers a corresponding segment to the other extension, and joins the resulting points to the opposite vertices of the base.

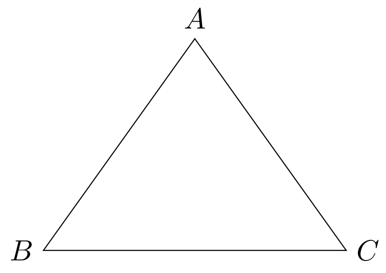
The following sequence shows the successive stages of Euclid's configuration.

5.2.1 Initial Isosceles Triangle

The construction begins with an isosceles triangle ABC satisfying

$$AB \cong AC.$$

At this stage no auxiliary points or segments have yet been introduced.



$$AB \cong AC$$

Figure 5.1: The initial isosceles triangle.

5.2.2 Extension of the Equal Sides

Euclid next produces the equal sides AB and AC beyond the base vertices. Let D lie beyond B on the line AB, and let E lie beyond C on the line AC.

Thus

$$A - B - D, \qquad A - C - E.$$

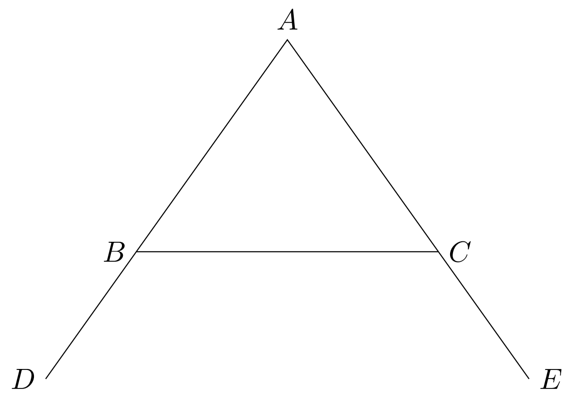


Figure 5.2: The equal sides AB and AC produced beyond B and C.

5.2.3 Choice of an Auxiliary Point

Euclid now chooses an arbitrary point F on the extension BD of the side AB.

Thus

$$A - B - F,$$

with F lying on the ray from A through B beyond the base vertex B.

5.2.4 Construction of an Equal Segment

Using Proposition I.3, Euclid marks a point G on the extension of AC such that

$$AG \cong AF.$$

The two auxiliary points are now related by the equality of the segments measured from the common vertex A.

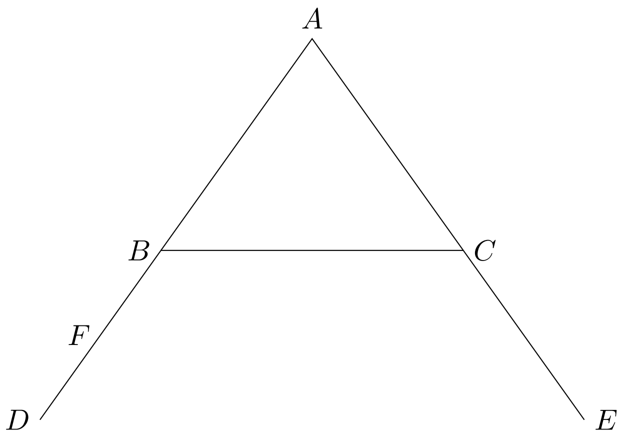
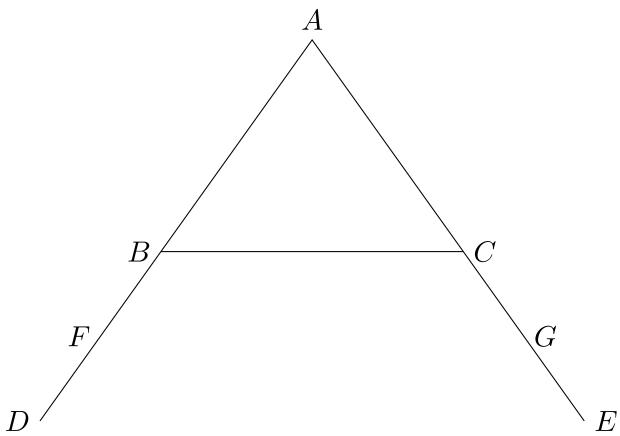


Figure 5.3: An arbitrary point F is chosen on the extension BD.



$$AF \cong AG$$

Figure 5.4: Construction of the equal segment $AG = AF$ using Proposition I.3.

5.2.5 Auxiliary Joins

The final step of Euclid's construction is to join the newly introduced points to the opposite vertices of the base.

The segments

$$FC \quad \text{and} \quad GB$$

complete the auxiliary configuration required for the proof.

5.3 Statement

Let ABC be a nondegenerate isosceles triangle satisfying

$$AB \cong AC.$$

Let the equal sides be extended beyond the base vertices so that

$$A - B - D, \qquad A - C - E.$$

Then

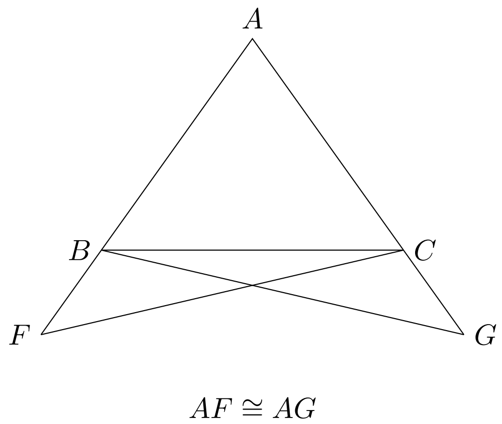


Figure 5.5: The complete auxiliary configuration used in Euclid's proof.

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB,$$

and

$$\angle CBD \cong \angle BCE.$$

Thus both the base angles of the isosceles triangle and the exterior angles formed after extending the equal sides are congruent.

5.4 Proof

Euclid's proof is considerably more elaborate than the modern reconstruction presented later in this chapter. Rather than reasoning directly from the properties of an isosceles triangle, he introduces an auxiliary construction that allows repeated applications of the Side– Angle–Side congruence theorem established in Proposition I.4.

After extending the equal sides of the triangle, an arbitrary point is chosen on one extension. Proposition I.3 is then used to construct an equal segment on the opposite extension. The newly obtained points are joined to the opposite vertices of the base, completing the auxiliary configuration.

The proof proceeds by applying Proposition I.4 twice. The first application establishes congruence relations between the auxiliary triangles and yields equal corresponding sides and angles. These newly obtained equalities provide the hypotheses required for a second application of Proposition I.4.

Finally, Euclid combines the resulting congruence relations with the elementary properties of equal segments and equal angles to conclude that the interior base angles of the original isosceles triangle are congruent. The same argument immediately establishes the congruence of the corresponding exterior angles formed after extending the equal sides.

The auxiliary construction is therefore not an end in itself. Its sole purpose is to transform Proposition I.5 into two successive applications of Proposition I.4, allowing the theorem to be derived using only previously established geometric results.

5.5 Implementation Architecture

The formal proof of Proposition I.5 is obtained by composing two previously established theorems of the Hilbert interface.

The first theorem establishes the congruence of the base angles of an isosceles triangle. The second theorem transfers this congruence to the adjacent exterior angles after the equal sides have been extended.

The resulting logical dependency is shown below.

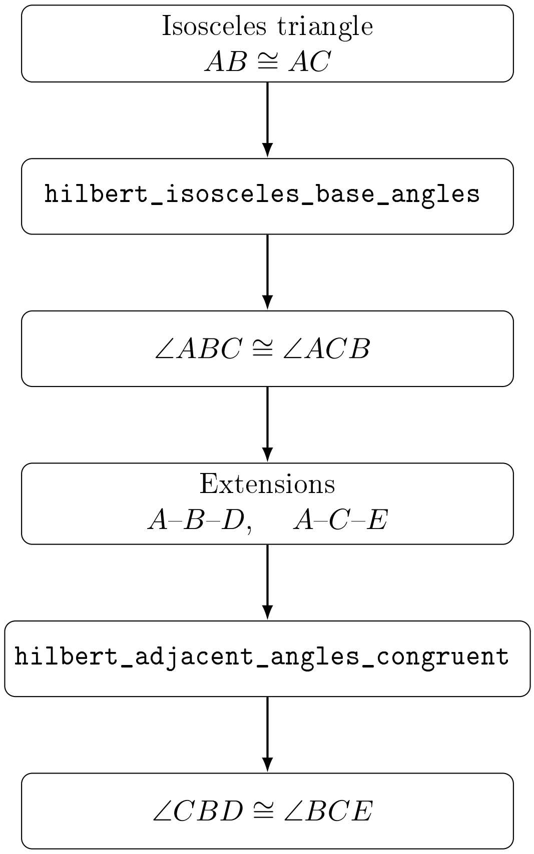


Figure 5.6: Implementation architecture of Proposition I.5.

Unlike the classical proof of Euclid, the formal development does not repeat the geometric argument establishing the base-angle theorem. Instead, the proposition is reconstructed by composing two independent results already available in the Hilbert interface. Consequently, Proposition I.5 illustrates the modular nature of the library: new Euclidean propositions are obtained by combining previously verified synthetic theorems.

5.6 Hilbert Reconstruction

The reconstruction of Proposition I.5 differs significantly from the classical proof presented in the *Elements*. Rather than repeating Euclid's geometric argument, the result is obtained by combining two previously established theorems of the Hilbert interface.

The first theorem,

`hilbert_isosceles_base_angles`,

states that the base angles of a nondegenerate isosceles triangle are congruent. Applied to the hypothesis

$$AB \cong AC,$$

it immediately yields

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB.$$

The second theorem,

`hilbert_adjacent_angles_congruent`,

uses the betweenness relations describing the extensions of the equal sides to transfer this congruence to the corresponding exterior angles.

Consequently,

$$\angle CBD \cong \angle BCE.$$

The reconstruction therefore introduces no new geometric machinery. Proposition I.5 is obtained entirely by composing two fundamental results already available in the Hilbert interface.

5.7 Lean Formalization

The Lean implementation follows the mathematical reconstruction directly.

The theorem first applies `hilbert_isosceles_base_angles` to obtain the congruence of the base angles of the isosceles triangle.

The resulting angle congruence is then supplied to `hilbert_adjacent_angles_congruent`, together with the two betweenness hypotheses describing the extensions of the equal sides.

The theorem therefore returns both conclusions of Proposition I.5:

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB,$$

and

$$\angle CBD \cong \angle BCE.$$

Unlike Proposition I.4, whose formal proof consists of a single application of the SAS theorem, Proposition I.5 is the first Euclidean proposition reconstructed as a composition of multiple interface theorems.

5.8 Discussion

Proposition I.5 marks an important transition in the reconstruction of Book I.

The earlier propositions are centred on elementary constructions and a single application of the SAS theorem. Beginning with Proposition I.5, most subsequent propositions of Book I are expected to be reconstructed by composing previously established interface theorems.

This modular organization differs substantially from the presentation of the *Elements*. Euclid develops each proposition as an independent geometric argument, whereas the present reconstruction emphasizes reusable formal components. The resulting proofs are shorter, their logical dependencies are explicit, and each proposition becomes a thin verification layer built upon the synthetic theory already developed in the Hilbert interface.

Chapter 6

Proposition I.6

6.1 Introduction

Proposition I.6 establishes the converse of the preceding proposition. Where Proposition I.5 proves that equal sides of a triangle imply equal base angles, Proposition I.6 shows that equal base angles imply the equality of the opposite sides.

This result completes the fundamental correspondence between the sides and angles of an isosceles triangle. Together, Propositions I.5 and I.6 establish the equivalence between the two defining properties of an isosceles triangle.

Euclid's original proof is considerably more involved than the modern reconstruction. It proceeds by contradiction, introducing an auxiliary construction obtained from Proposition I.3 and ultimately deriving an impossible configuration by repeated use of Proposition I.4.

In the Hilbert reconstruction developed in this project, the theorem admits a substantially shorter proof. The previously established Angle–Side–Angle theorem is sufficient to derive the equality of the opposite sides directly, eliminating the auxiliary construction and the reductio ad absurdum argument required by Euclid.

6.2 The Classical Construction

Euclid's proof begins with a triangle whose base angles are assumed to be equal. The desired conclusion is that the opposite sides are also equal.

Instead of arguing directly, Euclid assumes that the two sides are unequal and derives a contradiction. The proof therefore combines an auxiliary construction with a reductio ad absurdum argument.

The following sequence illustrates the successive stages of Euclid's construction.

6.2.1 Initial Triangle

Let ABC be a triangle satisfying

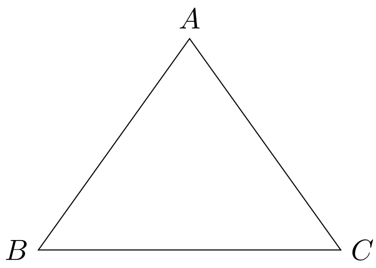
$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB.$$

At this stage no auxiliary construction has yet been introduced.

6.2.2 Assuming Unequal Sides

To obtain a contradiction, Euclid assumes that the two sides opposite the equal angles are not equal. Without loss of generality, suppose

$$AB > AC.$$



$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB$$

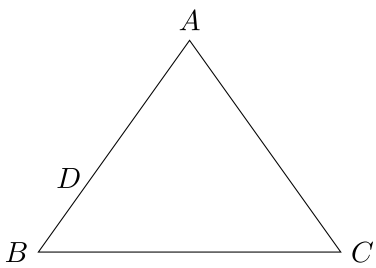
Figure 6.1: The initial triangle with equal base angles.

Using Proposition I.3, a point D is chosen on the segment AB so that

$$DB \cong AC.$$

Consequently,

$$A - D - B.$$



$$A - D - B, \qquad DB \cong AC$$

Figure 6.2: Assuming $AB > AC$, Proposition I.3 constructs D on AB with $DB = AC$.

6.2.3 The Auxiliary Triangle

The auxiliary point is joined to the remaining vertex of the original triangle.

Since

$$DB \cong AC,$$

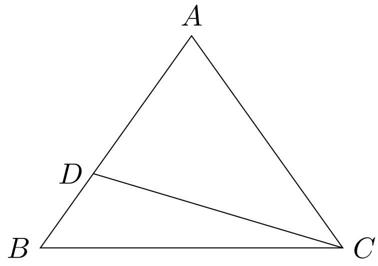
and the angle

$$\angle DBC$$

coincides with the original angle

$$\angle ABC,$$

the auxiliary triangle is prepared for an application of Proposition I.4.



$$DB \cong AC$$

Figure 6.3: The auxiliary triangle DBC obtained after joining D to C.

6.2.4 The Contradiction

Applying Proposition I.4 to the triangles DBC and ACB establishes their congruence. Consequently, the corresponding angles and sides are equal.

Since the point D lies between A and B, one of the resulting equalities contradicts the assumption that the whole segment AB is strictly greater than its proper part DB.

The contradiction shows that the assumption

$$AB > AC$$

is impossible. By symmetry, neither side can be greater than the other, and therefore the two sides are equal.

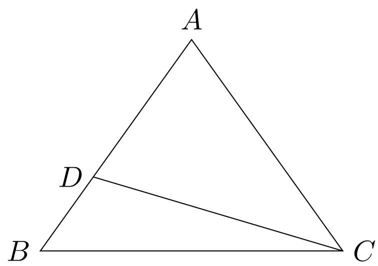


Figure 6.4: The auxiliary configuration from which Proposition I.4 forces a contradiction with the assumption $AB > AC$.

6.3 Statement

Theorem 1 (Euclid I.6)**.** *Let ABC be a nondegenerate triangle.*

If

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle ACB,$$

then

$$AB \cong AC.$$

That is, equal angles in a triangle subtend equal opposite sides.

6.4 Proof

Euclid proves the theorem by contradiction.

Assume that the sides opposite the equal angles are unequal. Without loss of generality, suppose that AB is greater than AC. By Proposition I.3, a point is constructed on the longer side so that the remaining segment is equal to the shorter side.

Joining the auxiliary point to the remaining vertex produces a second triangle. Proposition I.4 is then applied to show that the auxiliary triangle is congruent to the original one.

The resulting congruence forces equalities that are incompatible with the assumption that one side is strictly longer than the other. Since the assumption leads to a contradiction, the two sides must be equal.

Thus equal angles in a triangle necessarily subtend equal opposite sides.

6.5 Implementation Architecture

The formal proof follows a substantially different route from Euclid's classical argument. Rather than introducing an auxiliary point, constructing additional triangles, and reasoning by contradiction, the implementation exploits a higher-level theorem already available in the Hilbert interface.

The proof compares the given triangle with itself after exchanging the roles of the two equal angles. Since the common side is trivially congruent to itself, the derived Angle–Side–Angle theorem immediately implies the equality of the remaining sides.

Consequently, the entire classical construction disappears from the formal proof and is replaced by a single application of a previously established congruence theorem.

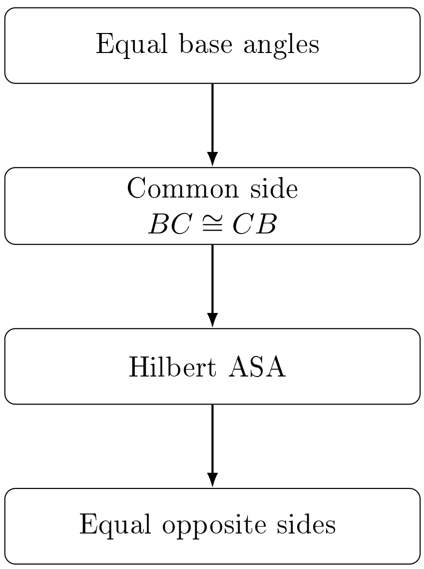


Figure 6.5: Architecture of the formal reconstruction of Proposition I.6.

6.6 Hilbert Reconstruction

The formal reconstruction replaces Euclid's indirect argument by a direct consequence of the developed Hilbert theory.

The key observation is that the given triangle can be compared with itself after exchanging the two equal base angles. The side BC is common to both descriptions of the triangle and is therefore congruent to itself.

The hypotheses of the derived Angle–Side–Angle theorem are thus immediately satisfied:

$$\triangle BCA \quad \longleftrightarrow \quad \triangle CBA.$$

Applying the Hilbert ASA theorem yields the congruence of the remaining corresponding sides,

$$BA \cong CA,$$

which is equivalent to

$$AB \cong AC.$$

Unlike Euclid's original proof, no auxiliary construction, no appeal to Proposition I.3, and no proof by contradiction are required. The entire argument is reduced to a single application of a previously established triangle congruence theorem.

6.7 Lean Formalization

The Lean implementation closely follows the Hilbert reconstruction.

The proof first rewrites the given triangle by exchanging the roles of its equal base angles. The common side BC is identified with itself using reflexivity of segment congruence, while standard symmetry properties convert the supplied angle congruence into the orientation required by the Angle–Side–Angle theorem.

A single application of the derived theorem `hilbert_asa_sides` then establishes the congruence of the remaining sides. Finally, elementary symmetry of segment congruence rewrites the result into the statement of Proposition I.6.

Compared with Euclid's original argument, the formal proof is substantially shorter because it relies on previously developed interface theorems rather than reconstructing the auxiliary geometric configuration.

6.8 Discussion

Proposition I.6 provides one of the clearest examples of the difference between a classical geometric proof and its modern formal reconstruction.

Euclid establishes the theorem by introducing an auxiliary point, constructing an additional triangle, and arguing by contradiction. The proof occupies a central place in Book I because it demonstrates how previous propositions can be combined to derive a converse statement.

Within the Hilbert framework, the same mathematical result becomes an almost immediate consequence of the previously established Angle–Side–Angle theorem. Once ASA has been derived from Hilbert's axioms, the converse property of isosceles triangles follows directly, without auxiliary constructions or reductio ad absurdum.

This proposition therefore illustrates an important principle of the CGJteamLab reconstruction: as the interface theory grows, increasingly complex classical arguments collapse into short applications of high-level synthetic theorems.

Chapter 7

Proposition I.7

7.1 Introduction

Proposition I.7 occupies a special position in Book I of Euclid's *Elements*. Unlike the preceding propositions, its principal purpose is not to establish a new geometric construction or a direct property of triangles, but to prove a uniqueness principle.

Euclid shows that, on the same side of a given base, there cannot exist two distinct vertices determining triangles whose corresponding sides are equal. This uniqueness result immediately precedes Proposition I.8, where it is used as a crucial ingredient in the classical proof of the Side–Side–Side congruence theorem.

The Hilbert reconstruction follows a different logical order. The general Side–Side–Side theorem has already been established within the Hilbert interface. Consequently, Proposition I.7 becomes a concise uniqueness argument derived from the developed congruence theory, without reproducing Euclid's original chain of auxiliary arguments.

This proposition therefore provides one of the clearest examples of the difference between the historical organization of Euclid's *Elements* and the logical organization of a modern axiomatic development.

7.1.1 Initial Configuration

Let AB be a given finite straight line and let C and D be two points lying on the same side of the line AB.

Assume that

$$AC \cong AD$$

and

$$BC \cong BD.$$

The proposition asks whether the two vertices C and D can be distinct under these assumptions.

Euclid's objective is to prove that such a configuration is impossible.

7.1.2 The Assumed Second Vertex

Suppose that the two vertices are distinct.

Both triangles share the same base AB, and their corresponding sides are assumed to satisfy

$$AC \cong AD, \qquad BC \cong BD.$$

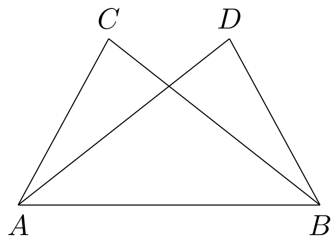


Figure 7.1: The assumed existence of two distinct vertices on the same side of the base AB.

Thus two different triangles would have the same prescribed side lengths while lying on the same side of the base.

Euclid proceeds by showing that this assumption inevitably leads to a contradiction.

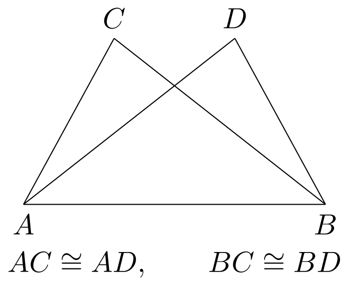


Figure 7.2: The two assumed triangles have the same base and equal corresponding sides.

7.1.3 The Contradictory Configuration

Euclid joins the two assumed vertices by the segment CD.

Since

$$AC \cong AD,$$

the triangle ACD is isosceles. By Proposition I.5,

$$\angle ACD \cong \angle CDA.$$

From the geometric position of the points, one of these angles is strictly greater than the corresponding angle formed with the base vertex B.

On the other hand, since

$$BC \cong BD,$$

the triangle BCD is also isosceles. Proposition I.5 therefore gives

$$\angle BCD \cong \angle CDB.$$

The same pair of angles is thus forced to be both equal and unequal, which is impossible. Hence the two assumed vertices cannot be distinct.

7.2 Statement

Theorem 2 (Euclid I.7)**.** *Let AB be a given base, and let C and D lie on the same side of the line AB.*

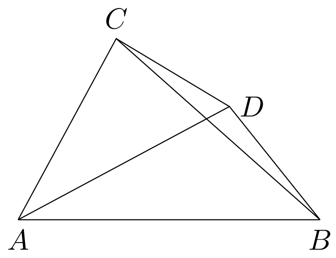


Figure 7.3: Euclid joins the two assumed vertices C and D and applies Proposition I.5 to the isosceles triangles ACD and BCD.

Assume

$$AC \cong AD$$

and

$$BC \cong BD.$$

Then

$$C = D.$$

Equivalently, on a fixed side of a given base there is at most one point having prescribed distances from the two endpoints of that base.

7.3 Proof

Assume, for contradiction, that C and D are distinct.

Join C to D. Since

$$AC \cong AD,$$

the triangle ACD is isosceles. By Proposition I.5, its base angles are congruent:

$$\angle ACD \cong \angle CDA.$$

Similarly, since

$$BC \cong BD,$$

the triangle BCD is isosceles, and Proposition I.5 gives

$$\angle BCD \cong \angle CDB.$$

The position of the points on the same side of the base forces one of these angles to contain the other as a proper part. Hence an angle would have to be congruent to one of its proper parts, which is impossible.

Therefore the assumption that C and D are distinct leads to a contradiction. Hence

$$C = D.$$

Thus, on a fixed side of a given base, a point is uniquely determined by its distances from the two endpoints of the base.

7.4 Implementation Architecture

The formal proof bears little resemblance to Euclid's original argument.

Instead of constructing auxiliary triangles and reasoning by contradiction, the implementation first applies the already established Side–Side–Side theorem of the Hilbert interface. This immediately shows that the two candidate triangles are congruent.

From the resulting congruence, the corresponding angle at the common base vertex is obtained. The uniqueness of angle construction then forces both candidate vertices to lie on the same ray issued from the base vertex.

Finally, since the two points lie on the same ray and are at the same distance from the common endpoint, the uniqueness of segment construction implies that the two points coincide.

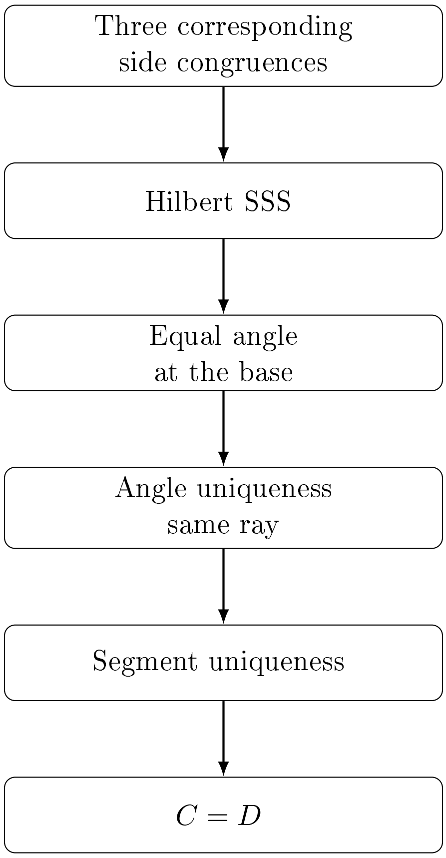


Figure 7.4: Architecture of the Hilbert reconstruction of Proposition I.7.

7.5 Hilbert Reconstruction

The Hilbert reconstruction follows a completely different line of reasoning from Euclid's original proof.

The three assumed side congruences are first combined with the nondegeneracy of one of the triangles. The previously established Hilbert Side–Side–Side theorem immediately yields congruence of the two triangles and, in particular, equality of the corresponding angles at the common base vertex.

Since both candidate vertices lie on the same side of the base, the uniqueness theorem for angle construction implies that they determine the same ray issuing from the base endpoint.

Finally, the two points lie on the same ray and are at the same distance from the common endpoint. The uniqueness of segment construction therefore forces the two points to coincide.

Thus the uniqueness statement of Proposition I.7 is obtained directly from the developed Hilbert theory, without reproducing Euclid's auxiliary geometric argument.

7.6 Lean Formalization

The Lean proof mirrors the Hilbert reconstruction almost step by step.

The proof first derives nondegeneracy of the two triangles from the assumption that the candidate vertices lie on the same side of the given base.

A single application of the theorem `HilbertSSS` establishes congruence of the two triangles and yields equality of the corresponding base angles.

The uniqueness theorem for angle construction then shows that both candidate vertices determine the same ray from the common base vertex. Finally, the uniqueness of segment construction implies that two points lying on the same ray at the same distance from the origin must coincide.

The complete formal proof is therefore a short composition of high-level interface theorems and contains no explicit geometric construction.

7.7 Discussion

Proposition I.7 illustrates a fundamental difference between the historical development of Euclid's geometry and its modern axiomatic reconstruction.

In the *Elements*, Proposition I.7 serves as an essential lemma for the proof of the Side–Side–Side congruence theorem in Proposition I.8. Euclid therefore establishes the uniqueness result before proving the general congruence theorem.

The Hilbert reconstruction follows the opposite logical direction. Once the general Side–Side–Side theorem has been derived from the Hilbert axioms, Proposition I.7 becomes an immediate uniqueness corollary obtained by combining triangle congruence with the uniqueness of angle and segment constructions.

This proposition therefore demonstrates that the historical order of the *Elements* need not coincide with the logical organization of a modern formal theory. As the interface develops, results that were once foundational become concise consequences of more general synthetic theorems.

Chapter 8

Proposition I.8

8.1 Introduction

Proposition I.8 is one of the central results of Book I of Euclid's *Elements*. It establishes the Side–Side–Side criterion for triangle congruence, proving that triangles having three corresponding sides equal must also have their corresponding angles equal.

Within Euclid's development, this proposition concludes a carefully prepared sequence of results. Proposition I.7 provides the essential uniqueness argument that allows the final congruence theorem to be established.

The Hilbert reconstruction follows a different logical organization. The general Side–Side–Side theorem has already been derived from the Hilbert axioms before the Euclidean propositions are reconstructed. Consequently, Proposition I.8 becomes a direct application of this general theorem rather than the culmination of a long geometric argument.

This proposition therefore marks the point where the historical proof of Euclid and the modern Hilbert reconstruction differ most significantly while establishing exactly the same mathematical result.

8.1.1 Initial Configuration

Consider two triangles,

$$\triangle ABC \quad \text{and} \quad \triangle DEF,$$

whose corresponding sides satisfy

$$AB \cong DE,$$

$$BC \cong EF,$$

and

$$AC \cong DF.$$

The objective is to prove that the corresponding angles of the two triangles are also congruent.

8.1.2 Superposition

Euclid conceptually places one triangle upon the other so that the vertex D coincides with A and the side DE lies along the side AB.

Since

Figure 8.1: Two triangles with three corresponding sides congruent.

$$AB \cong DE,$$

the endpoint E coincides with B.

The remaining vertex F must then lie at the intersection of two circles centered at A and B with radii equal to the corresponding sides of the first triangle.

Proposition I.7 shows that, on a fixed side of the base, such a point is unique. Consequently, the vertex F must coincide with C.

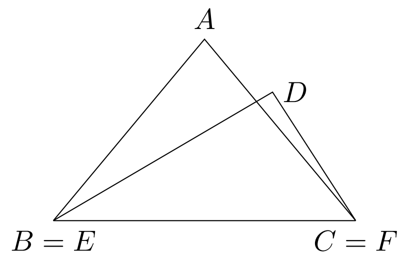


Figure 8.2: After superposition, the corresponding side $BC = EF$ coincides. If the remaining vertices A and D were distinct, Proposition I.7 would exclude this configuration.

8.1.3 Application of Proposition I.7

Once the triangles have been superposed, the only remaining possibility is that the third vertices do not coincide.

In that case there would exist two distinct points on the same side of the common base satisfying the same two distance conditions.

Proposition I.7 excludes precisely this situation.

Therefore the remaining vertices must also coincide, and the two triangles agree completely. Consequently, all corresponding angles are congruent.

8.2 Statement

Theorem 3 (Euclid I.8). *Let*

$$\triangle ABC \quad \text{and} \quad \triangle DEF$$

be nondegenerate triangles.

Assume

$$AB \cong DE,$$

$$BC \cong EF,$$

and

$$AC \cong DF.$$

Then

$$\angle BAC \cong \angle EDF,$$

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle DEF,$$

and

$$\angle ACB \cong \angle DFE.$$

That is, triangles having three corresponding sides congruent also have their corresponding angles congruent.

8.3 Proof

Superpose the triangle ABC onto the triangle DEF so that the vertex B coincides with E and the side BC lies along the side EF.

Since

$$BC \cong EF,$$

the point C coincides with F.

Suppose that the remaining vertex A does not coincide with D. Then there would exist two distinct points on the same side of the base EF satisfying

$$EA \cong ED$$

and

$$FA \cong FD.$$

This contradicts Proposition I.7, which asserts the uniqueness of such a point.

Therefore the vertex A must coincide with D, and the two triangles coincide completely.

Hence all corresponding angles are congruent:

$$\angle BAC \cong \angle EDF,$$

$$\angle ABC \cong \angle DEF,$$

and

$$\angle ACB \cong \angle DFE.$$

This establishes the Side–Side–Side congruence theorem.

8.4 Implementation Architecture

The formal reconstruction is dramatically simpler than Euclid's classical proof.

No superposition argument is required. Once the three corresponding side congruences are available, the previously established Side–Side–Side theorem of the Hilbert interface immediately provides the congruence of the two triangles together with the congruence of all corresponding angles.

The entire classical argument is therefore replaced by a single application of a high-level interface theorem.

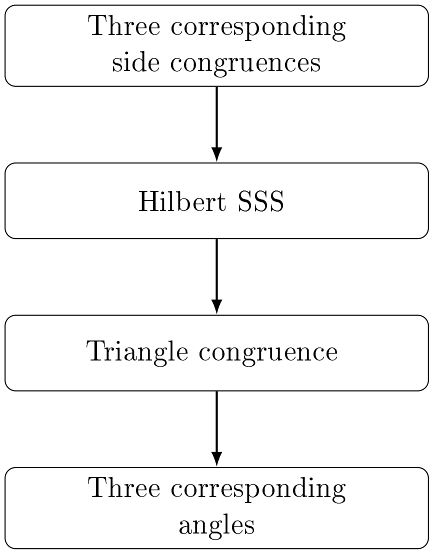


Figure 8.3: Architecture of the Hilbert reconstruction of Proposition I.8.

8.5 Hilbert Reconstruction

The Hilbert reconstruction consists of a direct application of the general Side–Side–Side theorem.

The three corresponding side congruences, together with the nondegeneracy of one triangle, satisfy exactly the hypotheses of the derived Hilbert theorem.

Consequently, the theorem immediately yields congruence of the two triangles and, in particular, congruence of all corresponding angles.

Unlike Euclid's original proof, no superposition argument and no uniqueness reasoning are required. These ideas have already been absorbed into the previously established Hilbert theory.

8.6 Lean Formalization

The Lean implementation follows the Hilbert reconstruction directly.

After assuming nondegeneracy of the first triangle and congruence of the three corresponding sides, the proof consists of a single application of the theorem `HilbertSSS`.

This theorem returns a complete triangle congruence result, from which the congruence of the three corresponding angles is obtained by projecting the appropriate fields of the resulting structure.

The formal proof therefore contains no auxiliary constructions, no superposition argument, and no separate uniqueness reasoning. These steps have already been incorporated into the previously established Hilbert interface.

8.7 Discussion

Proposition I.8 concludes the first major block of triangle congruence theory developed in Book I.

Historically, Euclid establishes the Side–Side–Side criterion only after proving the uniqueness result of Proposition I.7 and employing the method of superposition. The classical proof therefore depends on a carefully ordered sequence of earlier propositions.

The Hilbert reconstruction follows a different logical organization. The general Side–Side–Side theorem has already been established as a theorem of the Hilbert interface. Consequently, Proposition I.8 becomes a direct application of this previously developed result, requiring no additional geometric construction.

Together, Propositions I.4 through I.8 illustrate the progressive development of triangle congruence theory. The classical arguments of Euclid are systematically replaced by applications of increasingly powerful synthetic theorems derived from the Hilbert axioms.

This transition marks the completion of the first coherent layer of the CGJteamLab Hilbert interface and demonstrates how a modern axiomatic framework can substantially simplify the formal verification of classical geometry.

Chapter 9

Proposition I.9

9.1 Introduction

Proposition I.9 presents Euclid's construction of the bisector of a given rectilinear angle.

The classical proof combines several earlier propositions. A segment of one side of the angle is first copied onto the other side, after which an auxiliary equilateral triangle is constructed. The Side–Side–Side criterion established in Proposition I.8 is then used to prove that the joining segment bisects the angle.

The Hilbert reconstruction follows a different route. Rather than constructing an auxiliary equilateral triangle, it first lays off a segment congruent to one side of the angle, constructs the midpoint of the resulting segment, and finally applies the general Side–Side–Side theorem.

Although the geometric constructions differ substantially, both approaches establish the existence of an angle bisector within neutral geometry.

9.1.1 Initial Configuration

Let $\angle BAC$ be the given rectilinear angle.

The objective is to construct a ray issuing from the vertex A that divides the angle into two congruent angles.

No assumption is made on the lengths of the sides forming the angle; only the angle itself is given.

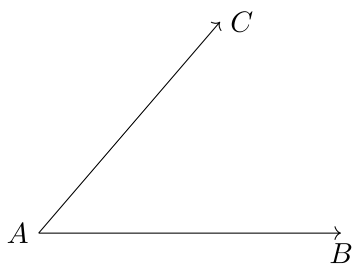


Figure 9.1: The given angle $\angle BAC$.

9.1.2 Construction

Choose an arbitrary point D on the side AB.

On the side AC, construct a point E such that

$$AE \cong AD.$$

Join the points D and E, and construct the equilateral triangle DEF on the segment DE.
Finally, join the vertex A to the vertex F.
The claim is that the segment AF bisects the given angle.

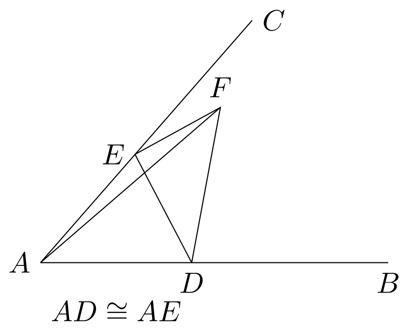


Figure 9.2: Euclid's auxiliary construction: $AD \cong AE$ and DEF is equilateral.

9.1.3 Application of Proposition I.8

Since the triangle DEF is equilateral,

$$DF \cong EF.$$

Moreover,

$$AD \cong AE$$

by construction, while

$$AF \cong AF$$

is common to the two triangles.
Therefore the triangles

$$\triangle ADF \quad \text{and} \quad \triangle AEF$$

have three corresponding sides congruent.
By Proposition I.8,

$$\angle DAF \cong \angle FAE.$$

Since D lies on the ray AB and E lies on the ray AC, these are precisely the two parts of the original angle $\angle BAC$.
Hence AF bisects the given angle.

9.2 Statement

Theorem 4 (Euclid I.9)**.** *Let $\angle BAC$ be a nondegenerate angle.*
Then there exists a point M such that

$$\angle BAM \cong \angle MAC.$$

Equivalently, the ray AM bisects the angle $\angle BAC$.

9.3 Proof

Choose a point D on the side AB and construct a point E on the side AC such that

$$AD \cong AE.$$

Join the points D and E, and construct the equilateral triangle DEF.
Finally, join the vertex A to the vertex F.
Since

$$AD \cong AE,$$

$$DF \cong EF,$$

and

$$AF \cong AF,$$

the triangles

$$\triangle ADF \quad \text{and} \quad \triangle AEF$$

have three corresponding sides congruent.
By Proposition I.8,

$$\angle DAF \cong \angle FAE.$$

Because D lies on the ray AB and E lies on the ray AC, these angles are exactly

$$\angle BAF \quad \text{and} \quad \angle FAC.$$

Hence the ray AF bisects the given angle.
This completes the construction.

9.4 Implementation Architecture

The Hilbert reconstruction replaces Euclid's auxiliary equilateral triangle by two fundamental constructions already available in the Hilbert interface.

First, a segment congruent to one side of the angle is laid off on the other side of the angle. The midpoint of the resulting segment is then constructed, and the Side–Side–Side theorem is applied to two auxiliary triangles.

Thus the existence of the angle bisector follows entirely from previously established neutral-geometric results.

9.5 Hilbert Reconstruction

Starting from the given angle, a point is first constructed on one ray so that the new segment is congruent to the side on the opposite ray.

The midpoint of the segment joining these two constructed endpoints is then obtained using the neutral midpoint theorem.

Finally, the triangles determined by the midpoint satisfy the hypotheses of the general Side–Side–Side theorem. The resulting angle congruence shows that the segment joining the vertex of the angle to the midpoint is an angle bisector.

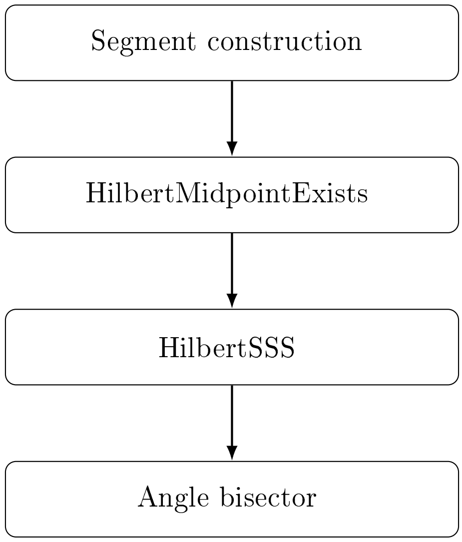


Figure 9.3: Architecture of the Hilbert reconstruction of Proposition I.9.

The proof therefore avoids both the construction of an equilateral triangle and the explicit application of Euclid's Proposition I.8, replacing them by previously established interface theorems.

9.6 Lean Formalization

The Lean implementation follows the Hilbert reconstruction directly.

Starting from a nondegenerate angle, the proof first constructs a point on one ray whose distance from the vertex equals the length of the opposite side of the angle.

The midpoint of the segment joining the two constructed endpoints is then obtained using the neutral midpoint existence theorem.

Finally, a single application of the general Side–Side–Side theorem establishes the congruence of the two auxiliary triangles. The desired angle congruence follows immediately after identifying the constructed segment with the original ray.

Unlike Euclid's original argument, the formal proof contains no equilateral triangle construction and makes no direct use of Proposition I.8. Instead, it relies entirely on previously established results of the Hilbert interface.

9.7 Discussion

Proposition I.9 is the first construction in Book I whose Hilbert reconstruction differs substantially from Euclid's original proof.

Euclid constructs an auxiliary equilateral triangle and applies the Side–Side–Side criterion established in Proposition I.8. The proof is therefore closely tied to the historical sequence of propositions in the *Elements*.

The Hilbert reconstruction adopts a different strategy. A congruent segment is first laid off on one side of the angle, the midpoint of the resulting segment is constructed, and the general Side–Side–Side theorem is applied directly to two auxiliary triangles.

This approach illustrates a general principle of the CGJteamLab library: classical geometric constructions are not reproduced verbatim when a simpler synthetic argument is available within the existing Hilbert theory.

Proposition I.9 therefore demonstrates how a modern axiomatic development can replace a classical construction by a shorter proof while preserving the same mathematical content.

Chapter 10

Proposition I.10

10.1 Introduction

Proposition I.10 constructs the midpoint of a given finite straight line.

In Euclid's development this construction depends on several earlier results. An equilateral triangle is first erected on the given segment using Proposition I.1. The vertex angle of this triangle is then bisected by Proposition I.9, and the Side–Angle–Side congruence criterion of Proposition I.4 is used to prove that the intersection point is the midpoint of the original segment.

The Hilbert reconstruction follows a fundamentally different approach. The existence of a midpoint has already been established as an independent theorem of the Hilbert interface. Consequently, Proposition I.10 becomes a direct application of this previously derived result.

This proposition therefore provides one of the clearest examples of the difference between Euclid's historical development and a modern axiomatic reconstruction.

10.1.1 Initial Configuration

Let AB be the given finite straight line.

The objective is to construct a point lying on the segment AB that divides it into two congruent parts.

Such a point is called the midpoint of the segment.

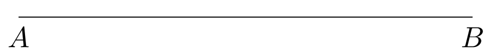


Figure 10.1: The given finite straight line AB.

10.1.2 Construction

Construct the equilateral triangle ABC on the segment AB by Proposition I.1.

Next, bisect the angle $\angle ACB$ by Proposition I.9.

Let the angle bisector meet the segment AB at the point D.

The claim is that D is the midpoint of the segment AB.

10.1.3 Application of Proposition I.4

Consider the triangles

$$\triangle ACD \quad \text{and} \quad \triangle BCD.$$

Since the triangle ABC is equilateral,

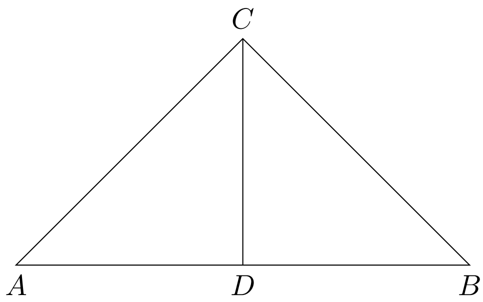


Figure 10.2: Euclid's construction of the midpoint of a segment.

$$AC \cong BC.$$

The segment

$$CD$$

is common to both triangles, and by construction,

$$\angle ACD \cong \angle DCB.$$

Therefore the hypotheses of Proposition I.4 are satisfied.
It follows that

$$AD \cong DB.$$

Since the point D lies on the segment AB, it is the midpoint of the given finite straight line.

10.2 Statement

Theorem 5 (Euclid I.10)**.** *Let AB be a finite straight line with*

$$A \neq B.$$

Then there exists a midpoint of the segment AB. That is, there exists a point M such that

$$A, M, B$$

are collinear,

$$M$$

lies between A and B, and

$$AM \cong MB.$$

Equivalently, every nondegenerate segment admits a midpoint.

10.3 Proof

Construct the equilateral triangle ABC on the segment AB by Proposition I.1.

Bisect the angle $\angle ACB$ by Proposition I.9, and let the bisecting ray meet the segment AB at the point D.

Since

$$AC \cong BC,$$

$$CD \cong CD,$$

and

$$\angle ACD \cong \angle DCB,$$

the triangles

$$\triangle ACD \quad \text{and} \quad \triangle BCD$$

satisfy the hypotheses of Proposition I.4.

Hence

$$AD \cong DB.$$

Because the point D lies on the segment AB, it is the midpoint of the given finite straight line.

This completes the construction.

10.4 Implementation Architecture

The Hilbert reconstruction replaces the entire classical construction by a previously established theorem of the Hilbert interface.

Rather than constructing an auxiliary equilateral triangle, bisecting an angle, and applying the Side–Angle–Side criterion, the existence of a midpoint is obtained directly from the general midpoint existence theorem.

Consequently, Proposition I.10 becomes a simple wrapper around an existing interface theorem.

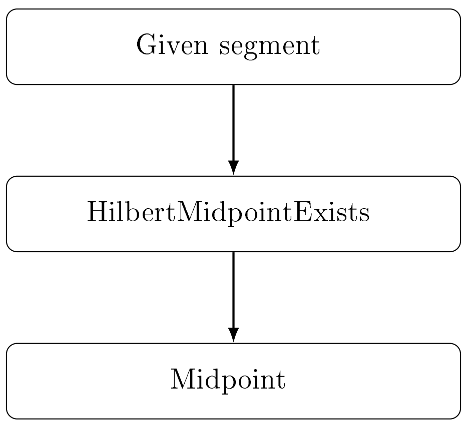


Figure 10.3: Architecture of the Hilbert reconstruction of Proposition I.10.

10.5 Hilbert Reconstruction

The reconstruction consists of a direct application of the general midpoint existence theorem.

Given a nondegenerate segment, the theorem `HilbertMidpointExists` immediately produces a point lying between the endpoints and equidistant from them.

No auxiliary geometric construction is required, since the existence of midpoints has already been established independently within the Hilbert development.

This represents one of the largest simplifications obtained by the layered architecture of the Hilbert interface.

10.6 Lean Formalization

The Lean implementation mirrors the Hilbert reconstruction exactly.

After assuming that the endpoints of the given segment are distinct, the proof consists of a single application of the theorem

`HilbertMidpointExists`.

This theorem immediately returns a point lying between the endpoints and equidistant from them, precisely satisfying the definition of a midpoint.

Consequently, the formal proof contains no auxiliary constructions and makes no explicit use of Propositions I.1, I.4, or I.9. All of the classical geometric reasoning has already been incorporated into the previously established Hilbert interface.

10.7 Discussion

Proposition I.10 provides one of the clearest illustrations of the difference between Euclid's historical development and a layered axiomatic reconstruction.

In the *Elements*, the midpoint construction depends on three earlier propositions. Euclid first constructs an equilateral triangle, then bisects one of its angles, and finally applies the Side–Angle–Side criterion to prove that the resulting point divides the original segment into two equal parts.

The Hilbert reconstruction is fundamentally different. The existence of midpoints has already been established as an independent theorem of the Hilbert interface. Consequently, Proposition I.10 becomes a direct application of this theorem, requiring no additional geometric construction.

This proposition demonstrates the principal advantage of the layered architecture developed in CGJteamLab. Once sufficiently rich interface theorems have been established, many classical propositions cease to be independent proofs and instead become concise applications of the existing theory.

Proposition I.10 is perhaps the simplest example of this philosophy, reducing an entire classical construction to a single theorem call.

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